



SOFTWARE USAGE POLICY

Version	Owner	Agreed by IT and Compliance	Agreed by Governing Body	Reason for amendment	Amended by	Next review	Further notes
v.1	Head of IT			This is the original version.	Head of IT	February 2025	



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A. Introduction

Corpus Christi College seeks to maintain the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information about its staff, students, visitors, and alumni, as well as its general affairs. It is extremely important to the College to preserve its reputation and the reputation of Oxford University and its integral parts.

Ensuring that good practice is maintained regarding the use and downloading of software on College-managed devices and self-managed devices with access to College networks and systems is an important part of this aim, and this policy sets out the ways in which the College defines the acceptable usage of software.

B. Information Security Classification

This policy represents part of the College's wider strategy for the management and integrity of its internal information systems and data assets, and as such will not be posted online.

Copies will be available on the internal policy SharePoint and from the Academic Registrar (policies@ccc.ox.ac.uk).

C. [Responsible Authority]

The Head of IT is responsible for this policy. They are responsible, with the support of the College's IT team, for ensuring that its stipulations are carried out and that they reflect best practice for usage of software at any given time. The Head of IT is also responsible for ensuring that this policy appropriately aligns with the College's wider strategy on information security and data protection.

Changes to this policy should be approved by the IT & Compliance Committee, who will comment on and/or approve revisions and will recommend policies to the Governing Body for final approval.

This policy should be reviewed in line with regulatory changes and guidance, and in response to the changing cybersecurity landscape in line with best practice, or at least once every three years (whichever is sooner).]

D. Policy Statement

The Software Usage policy sets out the standard processes for software install and the management of software licenses, and the measures which College members should and should not take in order that they use software in a proper way.

This policy is part of the College's wider strategy and thinking on information security, which is expressed in the **information security policy**.

E. Definition of Terms

There are no terms requiring further explanation in this policy document. Any questions regarding terminology should be directed to the Academic Registrar (rachel.clifford@ccc.ox.ac.uk) or the IT department.

F. Procedure

This section outlines the procedures that the College's IT department will follow in downloading and managing software packages on College systems and/or machines connected to the College networks.

Installation and support of standard software

The IT department provides a standard install for the Linux, Mac, and Windows systems purchased by the College from College or research grant funds.

Users may make additional software requests by contacting the IT department. If there are no cost implications and the use of the software has been appropriately checked, the IT department will endeavour to install the software on behalf of the requester (particularly if it is likely to be of general use to others).

Software installed as part of the departmental standard desktop install done by the IT department is supported to some level (although this support may be very limited). The IT team is not, however, expertly informed on the use of all software, and therefore for such software available support is limited to the running, update, and security of programmes.

Where possible, the IT department will make available software requested by individuals but this does not guarantee any specific level of support for that software. Support of a given application, as with any other IT system, is based upon the availability of support resources and the appropriate priority of the problem.

This is particularly of relevant to applications that are not generally required for research, teaching, or administrative functions of the department but have nevertheless been requested and provided.

The software installed may need to be reviewed as the system is updated and upgraded, and as such applications may be withdrawn if they cannot reasonably be supported at that time.

User install of software

Users may not install unlicensed software.

Users may install some licensed software themselves, subject to the limitations of the system setup, provided they do not breach any rules, licensing agreements, or similar constraints on use set out by the **acceptable use policy**. Any such software install by an individual has no guaranteed support from the IT team for that user, or anyone else who may try to access that installation.

The IT team will provide users with advice on installation and configuration of personally purchased machines, but will not provide an install and managed personal system service.



Software installed for laptops

After the initial installation of software the machine is handed over to the user to maintain and support in general thereafter. In line with the College's **acceptable use and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)** policies, users must ensure that laptops have up-to-date anti-virus software installed.

G. Scope

This policy applies to all users of software packages registered to College systems, or on user-managed devices using College networks, including those given temporary access as visitors and those using personal systems and/or devices.

The College has an additional **Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)** policy for self-managed machines and devices.

In line with the University IT department policy (**see section L**), software is only licensed (subject to software-specific terms) for those that have an Oxford University card with their status given as one of the following:

- Congregation
- University Staff
- Retired Staff
- Graduate (postgraduate student)
- Undergraduate
- Visiting Student
- Recognised Student
- College Staff
- Departmental Staff
- Academic Visitor

H. Training and Responsibilities

All staff who use software packages while connected to University or College networks, or who use packages installed on College-managed devices, must ensure that they abide by the **acceptable use** and **information security** policies of the College, and that they take due regard for data protection. Training on essential principles is provided to new joiners as part of the onboarding process through IHASCO.

The College IT team can only provide support for those software packages which are part of the basic installs that are carried out for Windows and Linux machines. Support for approved software packages installed by users, if they are outside of the general packages provided, is not guaranteed.

All users must ensure that they are aware of and abide by the stipulations of this policy, and that they follow the outlines given in the IT regulations:

<https://help.it.ox.ac.uk/software-usage-terms#collapse2117826>



I. Internal Help and Raising Concerns

Concerns that this policy and its stipulations are insufficiently rigorous or are not being adequately followed should be raised with the Head of IT in the first instance.

College members should be aware that any suspected or confirmed data breaches should always be referred to the College's DPO (DataGuard) as soon as they are discovered or suspected.

J. Consequences of Non-Observance

The College takes its management of information security and associated policies and procedures very seriously. Any deliberate violation of this policy and its guidelines may lead to disciplinary action.

Users should note that they are personally liable for any illegal activity they undertake or that occurs from their account or device (for example, should the College receive a cease and desist notice as a result of a user downloading software illegally, then the individual will be traced and any fines, charges, or other penalties passed on to the individual).

Individuals will be held personally responsible for any breach of the law.

K. Further Help

Questions regarding this policy should be directed to the Head of IT in the first instance.

L. Reference

This policy should be read in conjunction with the following College policies:

- **Information Security Policy**
- **Acceptable Use Policy**
- **Data Protection Policy**
- **Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Policy**

The College abides by the University of Oxford's IT department policy on software packages used by machines on College-managed networks. The policies for different software packages can be viewed here

(<https://help.it.ox.ac.uk/software-usage-terms#:~:text=The%20software%20may%20be%20used%20only%20whilst%20a%20member%20of,not%20transferable%20to%20other%20individuals>).

The licenses which IT policy stipulations cover are listed below in **section M**.

M. Appendices

The following products are those for which the IT services team has licenses, many of which fall under the JISC Standard Software License. For further information, please see www.help.it.ox.ac.uk.



List of Packages for which the IT Services have licenses

- Adobe Products
- Apple Mac Products
- Corel Academic Site License products
- Altiris Deployment Solution (this may be purchased by university units for installation on any machine located within the University site (10km radius of IT services). This software may not be used on personal machines off-site).
- EndNote Site License Agreement (This may be used on university or College-managed machines only).
- EndNote personal copies (This may only be downloaded on user-managed machines and devices, and must be deleted once the user's University card has expired).
- Hummingbird Connectivity Security Pack
- JRB Utilities software (This may be used on any departmental or College network within the University site. This must be used for educational purposes only).
- LIFT for Dreamweaver (This may be installed on University or College-owned machines only).
- Maplesoft departmental
- Microsoft Campus Agreement
- Microsoft Select Agreement (This is available only to departments and Colleges, and not available to staff using their own machines).
- Paintshop Pro
- Pcounter (This is for use on departmental and college owned machines only).
- Scientific Word (This is for use on departmental and college machines only. Staff may make a copy for use on a portable PC).
- SigmaPlot
- Sophos
- SSH Secure Shell (This software can be installed on any University or College-owned machine for non-commercial or charitable purposes. Personal copies for members of the university on home machines are permitted).
- SPSS
- ZENworks (This is available for purchase by units for installation on any machine (college, staff, or student owned) within the university site. It can also be used on home/personal machines by staff or students if they are connecting to the University network).
- ArcGIS (This software may not be used for the completion of paid research. The software may be used for research that is funded, providing that the researcher will personally own the outcome of their research).
- Mathematica
- Matlab (available for install by all Oxford University students, provided that it will not be used for commercial use).
- NVivo
- Oxygen XML Editor
- Cisco VPN